

Avila Optioned to Mexican Team

MEXICO CITY (UPI)—Holdout Bobby Avila meant it when he vowed to stay home all summer.

The 33-year-old Mexican native has been optioned to the Mexico City Tigers of the Mexican League after failing to reach a salary agreement with the Milwaukee Braves.

Avila arrived here Wednesday night and said the optioning was done at his own request.

Winner of the American League batting title in 1954 when he hit .341 for Cleveland, Avila spent 12 years in the major leagues. He played with Baltimore and Boston as well as Cleveland and Milwaukee.

Avila, used chiefly as a pinch hitter last season with the Braves, was placed on the major league restricted list recently when he did not sign his contract with Milwaukee. The Braves then agreed to assign his contract to Louisville of the American Association, from where he was optioned to Mexico City.